How to Read a Book

The Classic Guide to Intelligent Reading

By Mortimer J. Adler & Charles Van Doren

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SYNOPSIS & EDITORIAL NOTE

A practical methodology for elementary, inspectional, analytical, and syntopical reading across literature, science, and philosophy.

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CHAPTER 1 (PREVIEW)

The Activity and Art of Reading

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This is a book for readers and for those who wish to become readers. Particularly, it is for readers of books. Even more particularly, it is for those whose main purpose in reading books is to gain increased understanding.

Active reading is the effort to catch every ball the writer throws. A piece of writing is like a complex signal sent from one mind to another; the skill of the reader determines how completely that signal is received and reconstructed.